

The International Forum
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Journal of Search for Meaning

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THE INTERNATIONAL FORUM FOR LOGOTHERAPY is the official publication of the Viktor Frankl Institute of Logotherapy. It presents the meaning-oriented existential philosophy and therapy developed by Dr. Viktor Frankl and expanded by logotherapists throughout the world, working in counseling, education, medicine, nursing, psychology, social work, and other fields where the question of meaning becomes pertinent. The FORUM publishes experiential reports, theoretical papers, personal essays, quantitative, qualitative, and mixed methods research studies, practice and innovative logotherapeutic techniques for individuals and groups, and book and reviews. Case studies are not currently being published.

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Editors Introduction

Rodney B. Dieser Ph.D., CTRS, LMHC

This issue of the *International Forum for Logotherapy* holds two regular articles and two articles within the Logo-Philosophy Stories /Phenomenology at the Pool framework. The first, by Benjamin D. Aiken, shares his odyssey into meaning itself with his travels and adventures to the Pitcairn Islands, a group of four volcanic islands in the southern Pacific Ocean that form the sole British Overseas Territory in the Pacific Ocean. Aiken shares that his experience at the Pitcairn Islands revealed the timeless truths of Viktor Frankl's logotherapy. He found meaning in connection through shared meals, quiet walks, and laughter (experiential values). Aiken also discovered an act of artistry, a legacy crafted with care (creative values), and witnessed the human spirit enduring isolation and hardship (attitudinal values). The second article by Chad Nelson describes the benefits of a development-based (vs. performance-based) coaching framework rooted in problem-solving, which draws on cognitive-behavior therapy and logotherapy. In short, a coach walks an employee through five steps, which entail meaning as a guidepost for selecting a solution that also causes an employee's noetic dimension to be activated. The last two articles are in the Logo-Philosophy Stories /Phenomenology at the Pool structure of the *International Forum for Logotherapy*. To remind the reader, articles in this section are simple and engaging stories with logotherapy principles embedded in the story. No analysis, just a story where readers can individually find logotherapy principles. The first story, or third article in the *Forum*, is Ricki K. Saxton sharing her tender family experiences at Wally's Beach in Southern Alberta, Canada. The last article parallels the prior article written by Ricki K. Saxton; however, it is an excerpt directly quoted from Julie Schlarman's book on Eagle Point Park in Dubuque, Iowa (USA). This last article describes Julie Schlarman's family and friendship experiences at this historical and amazing park.

On a Bounty of Meaning: A Logotherapeutic Memoir of Pitcairn

Benjamin D. Aiken

In the vast expanse of the South Pacific, where the ocean stretches endlessly, and the modern world feels like a distant memory, lies Pitcairn Island—a place as legendary as remote. This tiny speck of volcanic rock is famously home to the descendants of the 1789 mutineers of the HMS *Bounty*, a rebellion immortalized in literature and film, with stories of Fletcher Christian and his companions becoming a tapestry of intrigue and survival. But beyond its tumultuous history, Pitcairn is a living paradox: an isolated community deeply connected to its roots, land, and shared humanity. My expedition to this extraordinary island was more than a physical journey; it was an odyssey into meaning itself. As an observer of the Pitkerners' lives—and as a temporary participant in their rhythms of simplicity and resilience—I found a bounty of meaning that resonated far beyond the confines of geography, offering lessons in connection, creativity, and the profound beauty of choosing one's path amidst whatever circumstances may be faced.

To reach Pitcairn Island is to journey far beyond the boundaries of familiarity—a voyage that mirrors the Hero's Journey (Campbell, 1949). My call to adventure was no ordinary trip, but a chance to observe, reflect, and uncover the existential truths of life in a place where isolation reigns supreme. My path spanned continents and oceans, unfolding in phases that tested body and mind. I first landed in Tahiti, an island with a bustling beauty surrounded by calm waters but humming with the pulse of modernity. Tahiti was merely a stepping-stone, though, toward remoteness. From there, two fleeting atolls appeared as fragile interruptions in the Pacific's vastness. They reminded me of how small humans are compared to nature's vast expanses.

The final leg, an almost three-day voyage from Mangareva in the Gambier Islands aboard an ocean freighter that a crane hoisted me upon from a dingy, marked my symbolic crossing into the unknown. The Pacific stretched endlessly, an unbroken expanse of water that seemed to dissolve the boundaries of time and space. Days merged into one another, carried by the quiet

rhythm of the waves. In that solitude, I encountered what Frankl (1985) described as a confrontation with oneself—a profound silence that became fertile ground for reflection. Meaning, as Frankl argued, often emerges in such stillness. For me, the vast, unyielding horizon became Campbell's (1949) threshold in the Hero's Journey: a liminal space of surrender, transformation, and growth. Then, as if summoned from myth, Pitcairn revealed itself—a jagged volcanic silhouette rising defiantly against the endless sky. In that moment, awe transcended words; it was a glimpse of what Frankl (1985, p. 37) might have called the "sublime."

Relational Ethics: My Aspirational Ethical Stance

The *Bounty of Meaning* highlights how our lives take shape through connections and the pursuit of significance. We exist within relational networks—families, friends, colleagues, and partners—that inform our identities and guide our meaning-making processes (Lapadat, 2017). Consequently, an autoethnographic account inevitably includes those whose lives intersect with my own (Ellis, 2007). From this vantage point, autoethnography intertwines personal experiences with broader social contexts, enabling deeper personal insight, facilitating healing, and inviting readers to share in our collective quest for human connectedness.

Portraying others, however, calls for more than standard ethical guidelines or purely rational frameworks (Schwandt, 2015). Instead, *relational ethics* (Ellis, 2007) underpins my aspirational stance. As Slattery and Rapp (2003) assert, it involves being “true to one’s character and responsible for one’s actions and their consequences on others” (p. 55). To maintain respect for those in my storytelling, I have occasionally omitted or altered details, thereby honouring their privacy while offering my personal story.

Frankl’s Meaning Triad

Frankl's concept of the *meaning triad* (1969) is central to understanding how individuals derive meaning. It comprises three distinct yet interconnected values: Experiential, Creative, and Attitudinal. Individuals may find experiential values in the meaningful moments we experience,

such as love, beauty, or connection with others. Frankl emphasized that these moments provide an immediate sense of meaning, allowing us to engage deeply with life as it unfolds. Creative values, on the other hand, arise through our contributions to the world—through work, art, or any form of creative expression that reflects our unique potential and desires. Frankl (1985) argued that creating something meaningful through actions or works is essential to human fulfillment. Finally, Attitudinal values emerge when we face suffering and the existential givens of existence, and they involve the conscious decision to adopt a meaningful stance in response to unavoidable circumstances. We can indeed find purpose even in the most challenging circumstances by choosing how we respond. Together, these three values offer a comprehensive framework for understanding how to discover and experience meaning in our lives, regardless of external circumstances.

Experiential Values: Meaning in Shared Moments

As Frankl (1969) described, experiential values arise when we immerse ourselves in life's moments. On Pitcairn, every experience appeared to brim with meaning, from my arrival at the dock to the simplest acts of sharing. The Pitkerners welcomed me with such profound warmth that I was immediately humbled. Many residents gathered to greet me on the docks, their faces open and their joy genuine. It was as though I had returned to a home I did not know I had. Their collective embrace was a lesson in a world dominated by individualism: life gains meaning through connection.

Over the days, I experienced life through their rhythm. Pitkerners invited me to their hillside homes, where I ate freshly pulled vegetables from their gardens and fruits plucked by hand. The taste of Pitcairn was more than sustenance; it was an expression of care. One afternoon, a woman placed a jar of honey in my hands—thick, golden, perfect. "This is the purest honey in the world," she said proudly. "Queen Elizabeth only wanted Pitcairn honey in her tea." It was not simply honey but a piece of their land, love, and legacy.

I became part of their gatherings in shared spaces like the town square and at the geological wonders of the island. They laughed, talked, and exchanged stories as naturally as breathing. I joined them at the commissary, open for only a few hours each week, where the locals traded necessities and conversation equally. Nevertheless, some of the most meaningful moments came in nature—hiking Down Rope, a treacherous 300-meter descent to the sea, and sitting at Christian's Cave, where the mutineer Fletcher Christian is said to have spent his days in watchful contemplation. The view from the cave—infinite sea meeting endless sky—became, for me, a sacred space for reflection. Like Christian, I sat in stillness, feeling time stretch and disappear. In these moments, I understood Frankl's insight that meaning arises when we fully experience beauty, connection, and presence (1985).

As I was preparing to depart Pitcairn, a Pitkerner-turned-dear friend approached me with a warm smile, holding a small container in her hands. Homegrown and freshly ground coffee was inside, cultivated from the rich volcanic soil behind her house. "This is from my garden," she said softly, her voice filled with pride and care. "Pitcairn gives us so much—may it remind you of this place." Her gift was simple but profound, a tangible expression of the island's essence. The aroma of the coffee carried with it the story of the island, its fertile land, and its people who shared themselves with me. In accepting it, I realized that giving was not about the coffee itself but a connection formed in a fleeting yet meaningful moment.

Creative Values: Co-Creating Life and Legacy

On Pitcairn, creativity is inseparable from survival. Pitkerners do not simply exist; they create their lives with intention. Frankl (1969) described creative values as the meaning we uncover through our contributions to the world. Pitcairn embodied this truth.

I witnessed creative values in the Pitkerners' work—crafting intricate keepsakes, operating the longboats, maintaining roads and the island's diesel generator—and other critical infrastructure

components, and helping one another to build their homes precariously perched above the hills. Nothing on Pitcairn happens without effort; this labour is shared and celebrated.

The commissary, though humble, was another act of creation. Pitkerners turned a space of scarcity into a place of abundance—an exchange not just of goods but also of stories and laughter. I marvelled at the way they crafted meaning in the simplest ways. The creative expression also thrived in storytelling. My host, a sixth-generation descendant of Fletcher Christian, shared tales of his ancestors under a canopy of stars. In his voice, history and identity intertwined. I realized that Pitcairn itself was a creation—a testament to endurance, legacy, and reinvention.

Attitudinal Values: Choosing Meaning in Isolation

Pitcairn's isolation, while profound, is not an imposition but a choice—a deliberate stance of embracing existence as it is. Frankl (1985) reminds us that we can choose how we respond even when we are suffering or experiencing limitations. Pitcairn stands as a testament to this choice. While on the island, I met a woman whose longing for a family of her own went unanswered—an ordinary heartbreak magnified by the isolation of Pitcairn. As the years passed, she never found the right partner to share her hopes of having children—a struggle echoed by many on an island whose population has been steadily declining. Yet Pitcairn continues to endure, shaped by the tenacity of those who choose to remain. With unshakable calm, she told me, “I could have left to start a new life somewhere else, but what would I be leaving behind? My family, my land, my roots? This is my home!” Her words encapsulated the attitudinal values championed by Frankl—a determination not to be defined by disappointment, but rather to find purpose within the very challenges that define island life. In doing so, she demonstrated the island’s remarkable resilience, reminding us that even under the weight of existential isolation, Pitcairn thrives on the resolve of those who refuse to abandon it.

Another man spoke of his sense of peace in the island's remoteness. "The world is noisy," he said, watching the horizon. "Here, we are quiet. Here, we belong." He had embraced the limits

of his geography and redefined them as his sanctuary. The very land itself echoed this lesson. At St. Paul's Pools, I watched waves collide with volcanic rock, exploding skyward in brilliant plumes. There was beauty in the violence—a metaphor for the resilience I saw in the Pitkerners. Just as the rock absorbed and reshaped the force of the sea, the people of Pitcairn embraced the hardships of isolation and turned them into purpose and meaning.

Their attitudinal choices impacted me deeply. I reflected on my life back home in Canada—its conveniences, distractions, and how I often resist moments of discomfort. On Pitcairn, I saw in action the freedom to stand firm and remain rooted in place and purpose despite external forces. In that stillness, I understood Frankl's assertion that we can find purpose even in isolation and suffering if only we can face it with courage and acceptance.

The Hero's Return: Lessons Carried Across the Sea

Reflecting on the cinematic portrayals of Fletcher Christian, I could not help but chuckle at the stark contrast between Clark Gable's 1935 portrayal in *Mutiny on the Bounty* and Mel Gibson's more emotionally tempestuous take in the 1984 remake. After spending time in the home of Christian's 6th great-grandson, I discovered that the Pitkerners, with their trademark humour and pragmatism, seemed to have a clear favourite. "Clark Gable had class," one remarked with a grin, "Mel Gibson just looked like he needed a good night's sleep." While they were far too polite to outright critique Gibson, it was clear that Gable's dignified, commanding presence felt more in tune with the legacy of their famous ancestor—less drama, more gravitas, and, as one Pitkerner joked, "better hair."

As the ocean freighter raised its anchor near Pitcairn's shore and began to sail west toward Polynesia, I stood at the railing, watching the island grow smaller on the horizon. In that moment, I felt transformed. The island had become my "belly of the whale" (Campbell, 2008, p. 90) to borrow Campbell's phrase, where I had paused, reflected, and been reborn with a new purpose. The Hero's Journey does not end with the return. It culminates in bringing the lessons home and sharing

the wisdom gained in the unknown. My journey to Pitcairn taught me that we can actively seek meaning—in the choices we make, the values we hold, and the relationships we nurture. I carried Pitcairn home with me—its honey, coffee, stories, and silences—and shared its lessons with my students, colleagues, and friends, retelling how a small island taught me that meaning is not about escaping isolation or hardship but embracing it with purpose. We can indeed find meaning when we face life as it is rather than as we wish it to be.

Limitations

In this Logotherapeutic memoir of Pitcairn Island, there is an inherent limitation in my perspective as a traveler. While I had the privilege of experiencing the island's profound meaning through shared moments, creativity, and attitudinal choices, I was, in essence, an outsider to the existential challenges faced by the Pitkerners. Frankl (1969) reminds us that meaning is found equally in extraordinary moments and everyday confrontations with suffering, isolation, and the search for purpose. Though seemingly removed from the complexities of modernity, the people of Pitcairn must face the existential givens of existence—such as death, suffering, and freedom—in a way that I, as a visitor, could not fully comprehend. I observed their resilience, but I was never genuinely embedded in their lived experience of grappling with the universal human struggles. As Frankl (1985) argues, it is through such existential confrontation that individuals forge meaning, and this is something I could only witness, not fully grasp. The depth of their lived reality—the quiet anguish, the sacrifices, and the intimate choices they make to give their lives purpose—remained largely invisible to me as a traveler. The meaning they create is, in part, a response to these existential realities, and I can only capture an external, partial view of the profound inner work they undertake each day. This memoir thus reflects the limitations of my understanding, highlighting that the Pitkerners' authentic encounter with the existential givens is a realm I could not fully enter, despite my deep respect for their choices.

Conclusion: A Bounty of Meaning

Pitcairn Island revealed the timeless truths of Viktor Frankl's Logotherapy. In its experiential values, I found meaning in connection—through shared meals, quiet walks, and laughter. In its creative values, I witnessed how survival became an act of artistry, a legacy crafted with care. In its attitudinal values, I saw the human spirit endure isolation—and hardship—and reclaim agency in the face of limitation.

Through the lens of Campbell's Hero's Journey, my time on Pitcairn became a transformative arc. I answered a call to adventure, crossed into the unknown, and returned with a treasure far more significant than I had imagined: the realization that life's most incredible meaning comes not from what we escape but from what we embrace. Pitcairn's people, land, unique history, and lessons have stayed with me. They remind us of all that meaning is always within reach, no matter how remote or challenging our circumstances may seem. Frankl taught us that life is indeed worth living if we dare to find the *bounty of meaning* hidden in its every corner.

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Problem-Solving in the Leader-Employee Relationship

Chad Nelson

Over the decades, there has been a growing phenomenon that has organizational leaders serving as coaches to their employees. In a coaching role, the leader will likely discover problems an employee is facing in the workplace. When a coach solves a problem for an employee, she may help the employee to cope with future problems but does not strengthen the capacity for that employee to solve problems in the future. In other words, the employee becomes overly dependent on the coach. Coaches should help their employees not to cope but to develop a more fulfilling mode of being (Graber, 2010); namely, develop an employee's ability to solve problems. This facilitates autonomy and competence, two psychological drives that can be harnessed through one's noetic dimension to solve problems in a meaning-filled way.

The following discussion describes the benefits of development-based (vs. performance-based) coaching. This method of coaching is uniquely positioned to utilize a logotherapeutic approach to problem-solving. A cognitive-behavior therapy (CBT) model of problem-solving will be shown to support development-based coaching, though not as robust as a logotherapeutic approach. Finally, a logotherapeutic model of problem-solving will be described. With its inclusion of meaning and one's noetic dimension, it is an effective model for development-based coaches.

Performance- vs. Development-based Coaching

During my more than 12 years in bank leadership, goals were at the forefront. These goals were set at both the branch and individual levels. Each loan officer and personal banker had individual goals that fed into the branch's broader goals. My role involved coaching these employees so as to meet their individual goals. A significant part of my responsibilities as a coach was to solve problems that inhibited goal attainment. So, when a personal banker was not meeting a goal, part of my job was to solve the problem(s) the banker was facing. This focus on employee

performance (goal attainment or lack thereof) and problem-solving is an example of what Stanier (2016) referred to as *performance-based coaching*.

Contrast this with *development-based coaching*. The essence of this coaching is not to solve problems for the employee but to develop the employee into a problem-solver. It recognizes the inherent or latent wisdom in employees by which they can solve problems in their work. When this happens, employees' sense of autonomy, responsibility, and self-efficacy are strengthened.

Development-based coaching is to partner with the employee as a problem is confronted. Such a partnership consists of exploring the problem and potential solutions *alongside* the employee, not *for* the employee (Clifford & Curtis, 2016). When I was coaching personal bankers and loan officers, I was not a partner, as such. I was essentially working *on* the problem, not *with* the employee.

In their study on organizational leaders who coach, Adele et al. (2023) pointed to research that identified several benefits employees experience when their leaders coach them: knowledge acquisition, increased job fulfillment and performance, and personal development. The researchers described such coaching as “facilitating . . . empowering behaviors” (p. 637). This depicts development-based coaching.

A CBT Model of Problem-Solving

CBT has a model of problem-solving that can be used in development-based coaching. In other words, a coach can use this with an employee as a *partner*. As detailed by Beck (2020), this method consists of two parts, each part possessing two questions. In a development-based coaching context, the process starts by the coach and employee working together to identify several potential solutions to a problem. Each solution is then ran through the two-part process. Again, each part contains two questions.

In part one, the coach asks the employee, 1) “If you do X, what are the advantages?” and 2) “If you do X, what are the disadvantages?” In part two, the coach asks the employee, 1) “If you do

not do X, what are the advantages?” and 2) “If you do not do X, what are the disadvantages?” The employee then reviews the answers and selects those that intuitively resonate.

A coach who uses this model guides the employee in problem-solving rather than solving a problem for the employee. This supports the employee’s autonomy and self-efficacy. However, responsibility is more implicit than explicit. Additionally, a key ingredient is absent: meaning.

A Logotherapeutic Model of Problem-Solving

The logotherapeutic approach to problem-solving facilitates a key tenant of logotherapy: an education to responsibility. In other words, it affirms that the responsibility (and capability) for problem-solving ultimately lies with the employee (Graber, 2010). Moreover, meaning is used to select and implement a solution.

In *Guideposts to Meaning*, Fabry (2021) described Elisabeth Lukas’s model of problem-solving. This model synthesizes the characteristics of development-based coaching, the CBT model of problem-solving, and logotherapy. Her model consists of five steps. Although the model is in the context of therapy, it is applicable to organizational coaching.

The first step is to help the employee define the problem. Specificity is crucial. To borrow from psychology, it may be thought of as operationalizing the problem. For example, suppose John tells his supervisor, “I’ve got a problem. My co-worker has a terrible attitude.” This is not sufficiently specific. However, John is getting much closer to operationalizing the problem when he says, “I’ve got a problem. My co-worker has a terrible attitude. He comes into my office roughly three times each day and complains about other people for 20 minutes. It zaps my energy and impacts my ability to get tasks completed according to their deadlines.”

Step two consists of identifying the employee’s area(s) of freedom. In this step, the coach helps the employee to write a list of aspects concerning the problem over which he has control and aspects which he must accept (has no control). In the previous example, an area of freedom might

be John's response to his co-worker. An aspect John must accept is his co-worker's attitude towards other people.

Step three entails writing out potential solutions that fit within the area(s) of freedom. When writing this list, the employee must not filter possible solutions for their utility, likelihood of being used, or seeming rationality. The goal is to write out solutions in an unfiltered manner. In John's situation, he might start by writing potential responses he can use when his co-worker comes into his office and starts complaining.

In the fourth step, the employee selects the solutions that are personally meaningful. Here, the coach can use Socratic dialogue with Fabry's (2021) guideposts to help the employee discover the solutions that are meaningful. For example, the *self-discovery* guidepost might be used to select a solution that allows the employee to use or discover a strength. Another option might be to use the *responsibleness* guidepost. This guidepost helps the employee to select the solution that permits him to exhibit his inner discipline to honor his commitments.

Finally, step five is to identify a possible first step in the direction of the chosen solution. The employee and coach brainstorm actions that align with the self-chosen, meaningful solution(s). The coach challenges the employee to take "a step forward, however small, in a new direction" (Fabry, 2021, p. 69).

This model harnesses an employee's noetic dimension. There are several components of this dimension: goals, creativity, commitments, love, ideals, responsibility, and decision-making (Graber, 2010). With this model's focus on responsibility and decision-making that is guided by meaning, an employee's noetic dimension is activated.

Summary

Development-based coaching is a method of coaching that affirms an employee's responsibility, autonomy, and self-efficacy when solving problems. Moreover, these characteristics

are strengthened through such coaching. This stands in contrast to performance-based coaching in which a coach works *on* (instead of *with*) an employee (Clifford & Curtis, 2016).

A CBT model of problem solving can be used in development-based coaching. It permits coaches to guide employees in the problem-solving process. However, employee responsibility is not an explicit component. Additionally, individual meaning does not have a role when solving problems.

A logotherapeutic model of problem-solving explicitly invites employees to take responsibility in the problem-solving process. A coach walks an employee through five steps, which entails meaning as a guidepost for selecting a solution. In this model, an employee's noetic dimension is activated such that a more fulfilling mode of being is experienced.

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Logo-Philosophy Stories /Phenomenology at the Pool Article

Wally's Beach

Ricki K. Saxton

I grew up in the tiny hamlet of Spring Coulee in the province of Alberta, Canada. Our house was just across the highway from the road that went to the St. Mary's Reservoir. Wally's Beach¹ is connected to St. Mary's and was a delightful place to spend a lazy summer afternoon. My Grandparents lived in a white house on the top of a hill – a short drive from the beach. After completing our jobs, on a typical day, we would put on swim gear, gather buckets and shovels, and throw what black innertubes we had into the back of our old blue Chevy truck. At the top of the hill, we would pick up Gram and down the gravel road we would travel with rocks flying until we came to the dirt road that led to the beach area. Back then, in the 70's and 80's, not many people knew of Wally's Beach, just the locals, so we had a private area to play, build sandcastles and float about. Getting from the parking lot through the mosquito infested grass area was tricky, but there was usually at least a small area of beach to play on. Gram loved us, and it was always fun to have her with us.

Many years later, I introduced Wally's Beach to my boys and husband. Several times the Saxton cousins all gathered there and had so much fun. In 2004, the year that my younger brother Kent died, we siblings took our kids down to the beach. It was a bittersweet moment as my younger brother, sisters, and I reflected on our childhood memories with Kent, it was easy to hear him laughing and splashing in the cool water. It was at Wally's Beach, where younger Kent tried to blow out a flaming marshmallow just as a gust of wind swept through and blew it onto his tender lips.

In 2022, I visited Spring Coulee for my mom's 80th birthday. One day, Mom and I drove up the hill to the spot where my Grandparents had lived. The house is gone now – torn down, but

¹ Wally's Beach is located on the St. Mary Reservoir Provincial Park and Recreation Area by Spring Coulee, Alberta, Canada.

Mom and I walked around the area and shared memories. We figured out where Gram's flower beds had been – her snapdragons – and where the house had been located. The wind was blowing of course, it is always windy in Southern Alberta, and I missed my Gram and my childhood. Gram and I created things whenever it was my time to stay overnight with her and Grandpa. I loved doing crafts, so one time we made apple people. It was quite the process. First, we had to peel apples and carve a face into them. We put googly eyes in the carved sockets, and then we had to let the apples dry and shrink. Several weeks later, we made wire bodies for our people and Gram made simple clothes for them. The last touch was yarn hair. I still have my apple couple – they are sitting in my doll cabinet today. One time, when my grandparents were visiting, over twenty years after our apple creation, I brought out the apple couple to show Gram that I still had them. Gram cried when she saw them – so many good memories. The year before Gram died at the age of 103 years old, I called her and thanked her for spending time with me when I was a little girl – we both cried.

Today Wally's Beach has become a popular recreational area with bathroom facilities and established camping sites. The dirt road is now paved, but my memories will always be there with my brothers, sisters, my parents and Gram.

Bio: Ricki K. Saxton B.A. has served as a youth leader for twenty plus years at her local church in Cedar Falls/Waterloo (Iowa). She rescues animals and operates a small business.

Eagle Point Park: An Excerpt from Julie Schlarman's book "The Park"

Rodney B. Dieser

Eagle Point Park in Dubuque, Iowa, is listed on the National Register of Historic Places. Although the park opened in 1909, its distinction rests on its unique Prairie style architecture, designed and created by Alfred Caldwell in the 1930s. The Prairie style architecture, prominently featured in the park's pavilions, garden beds, lily pond, and other structures, reflects the strong influence of Frank Lloyd Wright, who Caldwell viewed as his mentor.² Many of the native stone shelters, with some of the most distinctive and exceptional fireplaces and firepits (that are still in use today), were patterned and imagined from Caldwell's trips at the Taliesin Fellowship, Frank Lloyd Wright's architectural school located in Spring Green, Wisconsin. In addition, Eagle Point Park's scenic views of the Mississippi River and the meeting point of Iowa, Illinois, and Wisconsin are breathtaking. To parallel the article above, where Ricki K. Saxton shares her memories of Wally's Beach, the excerpt below is a direct quotation from the book of Julie Scharman, *The Park* (2021), about her childhood memories of Eagle Point Park.

Julie Schlarman Excerpt

My childhood experiences [of Eagle Point Park] were full of wonder and endearing memories of family. Every visit started and ended with a procession through the entire park, slowing at spots to allow deer to cross, to admire the view or perhaps to catch sights of someone we knew. There was a catch in my throat each time we made the curve in the East Room and headed down to the Riverside pavilion . . . We could have been there just to get out of the heat and away from the bugs in the city, to cool off in the wading pools, catch lightening bugs as the shadows were setting in for the day or for a quiet picnic dinner. Large family get togethers always had the best foods – grandmas' potato salad, mom's coleslaw, Aunt Betty's fluff, grilled hot dogs from

¹ To learn more about Alfred Caldwell, his relationship with Frank Lloyd Wright, his later historical work found in the Chicago Park District and his work as a faculty member at the architecture school of Illinois Institute of Technology, see Domer (1997). Frank Lloyd Wright (1867-1959) was an architectural genius and one of the the most accomplished architect of all time. In 1991 he was recognized by the American Institute of Architects as the greatest American architect of all time.

Trenkle's and sometimes chocolate to please grandpa. Galvanized tubs were filled with mountains of ice, bottles of soda, beer and covered by old wool blankets. Dads of many ages manned the grills, each with their own science of barbeque. Row upon row of picnic tables were covered in red and white checkered tablecloths which had to be anchored by bowls of goodies for fear that the slightest breeze would make them airborne. My uncles would organize the games. Being a typical Dubuque family, there were always enough eager participants to complete both sides of a baseball team, with the leftovers creating new positions in the outfield. On smaller occasions it might be badminton or volleyball or the great good fortune if someone remembered the horseshoes. The park was the perfect place for these events – birthdays, family reunions, wedding receptions – a place where community becomes family . . .

My most vivid memories . . . I loved each spring when my Girl Scout troops would plant flowers in the Ledge Garden, or we would spend a week of day camp resting our bums on dirt laden 'sit upons.' The picnic breakfast was the ultimate luxury, like camping but more civilized. Mornings were heaven in the park, the quietude, the cool dampness on your feet, the lonely hum of a fishing boat on the river below, birds singing only for you. The Park could be yours in the morning, but you had to be willing to share it with its permanent residents. One particular breakfast spent with friends in the isolated council rings by the Ledge Gardens disturbed the resident chipmunks who expressed their displeasure by sitting on the top of the ring and chattered at us. Not even peace offerings of strawberries and coffeecake quieted them. Another exceptional winter morning my dad took my brothers and I into the park from the back gate to catch a view of the eaglets in a nest seemingly levitating over the edge of the bluff. The Park could allow you to feel like you were in a place that was wild.

Then I grew up, or at least I thought I had. The Park continued to play an important role in my life [during high school] . . . Summer days were spent with friends sitting at picnic tables, laughing, walking, swinging, youthful dalliance in the woods, and not knowing or caring how

much our lives would soon change forever. Our favorite spot in the summer of 1976 was in the ‘middle’ of the park, near the water tower, the same water tower my grandfather had painted, the one where a gust of wind swept him off his scaffolding, and he hung by one leg until his boss came along and accused him of goofing off . . . My life journey has taken me to many places . . . I learned that home -- Dubuque, the county, the Mississippi, Eagle Point Park – is remarkable.

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Reference

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